Michaela Usanga

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PROFILE

Frontend Engineer with a First Class BSc (Hons) in Computer Systems Engineering and over a year of hands-on software delivery across contract, full-time and volunteer roles. Implements features and fixes in React, Next.js, and TypeScript within code-reviewed workflows, building reusable, unit-tested components that keep codebases consistent. Has owned frontend delivery end to end in small teams, from proposing the stack and design system to building and shipping features. Available immediately.

EDUCATION

University of Sunderland **Graduated Jul 2025**

BSc (Hons) Computer Systems Engineering — First Class Honours *Sunderland, UK*

- Co-founded the university's first Developers Society (Vice-President); the society became the first UK community admitted to the Google AI Community Network.

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer (Contract) **Apr 2026 – Aug 2026**

PACE Rail Ltd *Remote, UK*

- Redesigned the report builder of a **React** programme-control platform used by Network Rail regional teams, replacing a long form users had avoided with a two-pane, paginated builder whose live preview reuses chart components; authors now see and rearrange output by drag-and-drop before generating it.
- Replaced hardcoded colours with a design-token system generating **CSS** custom properties, enforced by an automated lint test, giving the team one source of truth for styling and stopping new hex values re-entering the codebase.
- Proposed and led the move to **Tailwind CSS**, writing the migration guide and migrating authentication, landing, header and footer views; CSS contracts consumed by the backend PDF pipeline were preserved so reports kept rendering unchanged.
- Built a documented, tested shared component library with **Vitest** and **React Testing Library** and migrated 9 data tables onto it; a fix or behaviour change is now made once rather than per page.

Web Developer **Jan 2026 – Apr 2026**

Abbexa Ltd *Cambridge, UK*

- Rebuilt the storefront that is the company's main sales channel; proposed the **Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS** stack to replace the legacy OpenCart 2 site and won the senior developer's agreement.
- Built the new storefront as typed, reusable section components fed by an **OpenCart REST API**, with backend HTML sanitised before rendering; the marketing team could edit content from the existing admin without waiting on a developer and without injecting markup into the live site.
- Established the website brand-token system and implemented responsive and accessible layouts; every page inherits the brand without re-styling.

Software Engineer (Volunteer) **Jul 2025 – Dec 2025**

FirstMove Labs *Remote, UK*

- Replaced an email-capture landing page with a full marketing site in **Astro** and **Tailwind CSS** built from Figma designs, reaching Lighthouse accessibility scores of 97; the site became the app download route leading to 670+ users and the brand-search ranking rose from page 4 to page 1.
- Integrated Intercom into the **Laravel** API so that each app sign-up created a verified contact, with identity verification and duplicate-request guards keeping the contact list clean; users were reachable for support and onboarding.
- Wrote and built a six-part onboarding email series in Intercom on top of the contact flow, so every new sign-up received guided onboarding automatically rather than arriving in the app cold.

Frontend Developer Intern (Finalist) **Sep 2023 – Nov 2023**

HNG Tech *Remote*

- Finalist (one of top 280 of 15,220+); built five individual projects (TMDB movie app, drag-and-drop gallery, Chrome screen-recording extension, etc.) and owned the shop product-details page of a team product in **Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind**.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Women Coding Community **Oct 2025 – Present**

- Implemented features and fixed bugs to enhance the user experience of the Women Coding Community (WCC) website.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, Python, Java, PHP, SQL

Libraries & Frameworks: React, Next.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Astro, TanStack Query, shadcn/ui, Vitest, React Testing Library

Developer Tools: Git, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Docker, Lighthouse, Vite, Postman, Figma, Jira, Claude Code, Copilot, Cursor

Platforms: AWS, Vercel, Firebase